

STORYTABLE

User Manual

Edition 0.1.331

Plan from evidence. Build with intention. Review before you publish.

Windows and macOS Workspace

www.storytable.app/manual

The manual edition matches the application release.

*StoryTable Workspace UI**Edition 0.1.331 - Windows and macOS**Current online copy: <https://www.storytable.app/manual>*

This manual describes the current installed Workspace, not the retired Classic screens. Its edition must match the StoryTable release that contains it. The same versioned PDF is packaged with the desktop app, attached to the public release, and published at the online address above.

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1. What StoryTable does

StoryTable is a source-grounded story-production workspace. It turns briefs, documents, interview transcripts, recordings, images, and reusable creative direction into an ordered plan that you can inspect before StoryTable writes, illustrates, or exports anything.

Use it to build social posts, presentations, illustrated pages, interview edit scripts, storyboards, articles, schedules, and other structured deliverables. StoryTable keeps the source evidence, editorial instructions, page plan, generated versions, and publication files connected instead of treating each AI request as an isolated prompt.

StoryTable is deliberately not a one-click black box. The important checkpoints are visible: review the source material, confirm the audience and goal, inspect the outline, verify exact quotations, approve page direction, and then create or export the result. AI-supported actions propose work for review; local verification protects exact transcript evidence and supplied-image pixels where the workflow requires them.

The normal Workspace workflow is:

1. Create a project from a brief, source document, Template, or existing project.
2. Use Plan to establish evidence, audience, goal, output direction, and the ordered Page Outline.
3. Use Create to generate the planned writing, imagery, or production assets.
4. Use Refine to edit, compare, regenerate, restore, skip, or lock work.
5. Use Publish to export a verified handoff package for the selected output.

StoryTable keeps user-created project files in a local folder that you choose. Reusable library definitions and protected application data are separate from project folders.

The evidence rule

StoryTable distinguishes source evidence from creative direction. A transcript, source document, project brief, or reviewed source image may establish facts. Goals, Writing Styles, Channels, Instruction Assistants, and text entered into an AI-direction dialog tell StoryTable what to do with those facts; they do not create new evidence.

When exact wording matters, keep it in Transcript Evidence, not only in Page Text. StoryTable can then verify that wording against an imported transcript, retain its speaker and time range, and reject an invented or paraphrased replacement. Always review the proposed selection in context before publishing.

Important terms

- Project brief: the editable source of truth used to plan the project.
- Page: one ordered unit of the result, such as a slide, carousel image, poster, or illustrated story page.
- Source document: supporting written material attached to the project.
- Primary source: the document StoryTable should treat as the central evidence source. TXT, Markdown, SRT, PDF, DOCX, CSV, and HTML documents can be marked primary in Plan; formats that do not use the legacy single-source slot remain fully available through the multi-document planner.
- Source image: an image StoryTable can read for visible text, meaning, facts, and caption ideas.
- Transcript evidence: exact source words, speaker, source file, and time range kept separate from authored page text.
- Soundbite: one verified quotation or an explicitly marked splice of same-speaker transcript segments.
- Script anchor: the exact user-authored objective, outline beat, heading, or script passage where a selected soundbite is meant to appear.
- Page reference: a supplied image attached to a particular page for provider-integrated unchanged use, faithful recreation in a selected style, or loose inspiration for new artwork.
- Faithful Reference Image: a Visual Style reference whose depicted subject remains recognizable when applying the selected rendering medium; it is used by default unless a specific page requirement clearly favors another supplied source.
- Current image: the active generated or supplied image version for a page.
- Needs Image Regeneration: the current image no longer matches an image-affecting page instruction.
- Locked: protected from replacement, regeneration, removal, and bulk image actions until explicitly unlocked.
- Skipped: excluded from Create Missing, Create Selected, and Create All without deleting image history.
- Revision: an immutable generated image version retained in the project.
- Library item: a reusable Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, or Character.

2. Workspace at a glance

The left sidebar is divided into three areas.

The Active Library dropdown sits at the upper left, below the StoryTable logo and above Current Project. It stays available as you move between workspaces, with or without a project open.

Projects

- All Projects opens or creates projects.
- Recent shows recently used projects.
- New Project starts the guided project wizard.

Current Project

These destinations appear when a project is open:

- Overview
- Plan
- Create
- Refine
- Publish
- Files

Workspace

- Libraries
- Batch Projects
- Account & Usage
- Settings

Header and progress display

The header shows the project name, project readiness or warning state, account state, and Save.

An operation progress display stays near the top of the Workspace while work is running. A highlight moves across the bar so you can see that StoryTable is working even while a provider request is waiting. The current action and completed steps appear when available; an unknown total does not show an invented percentage. The same activity feedback appears in Library AI editors, AI writing and refinement, and the New Project wizard.

Source-based planning and opportunity discovery report four phases: preparing the project, reading and analyzing sources, building/checking the outline or opportunities, and saving the result. The phase heading stays visible alongside the current source/section detail. Provider queue and waiting messages appear separately instead of replacing that detail. Percentages describe progress within the current phase; a phase with an unknown duration keeps an activity indicator.

The Elapsed timer reports wall-clock time, including provider waits and any pauses. It freezes when the job finishes, before you spend time reviewing a result. Completed in, Failed after, or Stopped after remains visible with the final duration until another job starts. Job titles, outcomes, and durations are also recorded in StoryTable's support logs. Cancel is available during supported operations; Pause and Resume appear when the operation supports pausing. StoryTable prevents conflicting long-running operations from starting at the same time.

Hosted generation can take more than five minutes. While the service continues reporting that the task is queued or running, StoryTable follows the same task until it finishes. The moving highlight and elapsed timer stay active. The connection timeout limits individual network requests, not the full generation run.

Stop ends desktop waiting; the original hosted task may continue. StoryTable preserves its identity for a later status check. See An operation was interrupted for stopping and reconnecting.

Buttons with the OpenAI logo submit an AI-supported action and may consume account credits. Buttons without the logo perform local or non-AI actions.

Context-aware work areas

StoryTable uses the active project's resolved Goal, Deliverable, Template, Channel, source material, and current page to decide which specialized work areas apply. A specialist work area that does not apply is removed from the layout, so you do not have to scroll past controls intended for another kind of project.

- Lyric & Motion Details appears only for lyric interpretation, timed lyric video or motion/storyboard outputs, or a page explicitly classified as lyric/kinetic/motion/storyboard.
- Transcript Evidence and the soundbite tools appear only when StoryTable recognizes actual transcript provenance: an SRT, a transcribed recording, a transcript- or interview-labeled source, a transcript-specific workflow with attached sources, or an explicit primary text transcript. Ordinary PDFs, DOCX or background notes, and compatibility text extracted from a PDF do not enable them. Name Speakers appears only after speakers have been detected.
- Structured Event Poster fields have equivalent event/poster gating.
- Text-only outputs hide visual identity, artwork direction, page-photo, and character controls. Their Plan labels change from presentation and page-plan language to writing and document language.
- Event Editorial Desk replaces the ordinary Plan phases with its own transcript, Coverage Brief, and story-opportunity workspace while that Goal is active.

3. Quick start

Create, generate, and publish a simple project

1. Choose New Project.
2. Select Write a project brief.
3. Enter what StoryTable should create, including verified facts, goals, priorities, and exclusions.
4. Choose Next.
5. Name the project, choose its local save location, and choose an output type.
6. Identify the audience and destination.
7. Choose writing, visual, brand, size, orientation, and text-in-image direction.
8. Review the summary and create the project.
9. StoryTable opens Plan. Review the project brief and direction.
10. Build or edit the Page Outline.
11. Save the plan.
12. Open Create and choose Generate Page Text if pages do not yet exist.
13. Review the pages, then choose Create Missing Images, Create Selected Images, or Create All Images.
14. Open Refine to edit, regenerate, compare, or lock images.
15. Open Publish, review the package preview, choose a destination, and select Export Publication Package.

Start from interviews or a recording

1. Create the project and open Plan.
2. Choose Add Documents for existing transcripts, or Transcribe Recording... for an audio or video file.

3. For a recording, review the generated timestamped SRT and use Name Speakers... when detected speaker labels should be replaced with real names.
4. Set every interview's Purpose to Interview transcript so the interviews are considered as peers. Use Background/context for material that must not supply quotes, and Excluded for files that must not be used. Add source-specific evidence instructions in the notes.
5. Set the Goal, Deliverable, audience, Channel, Writing Style, and any duration or required-content constraints.
6. Create or update the Page Outline. StoryTable analyzes every included transcript in full before assembling the story. Follow the source/section progress and review how the interviews are interwoven; peer treatment does not promise equal screen time.
7. On an exact-quote page, choose Find Another Soundbite... beside Page Text to request a different source-grounded quotation without inventing or paraphrasing words.
8. Review the proposed quote, speaker name, transcript filename, time range, and exact transcript match before applying it. A splice shows this attribution separately for every component.

4. Create a project

Choose New Project in the sidebar or File > New Project. The wizard uses the currently selected Active Library, so its Templates, Goals, Deliverables, Channels, Writing Styles, Instruction Assistants, Visual Styles, Brands, Layouts, and Characters come from the same reusable Library profile you see in Libraries.

Step 1: Choose a starting point

The guided wizard offers four starting points.

Start from an existing document

Choose a plain-text, Markdown, or text-based PDF source. StoryTable validates the file before continuing.

- Image-only PDFs are not accepted as primary text sources.
- DOCX is not offered by this wizard shortcut. Add it in Plan after creating the project; it can then be assigned the Primary source purpose.
- The selected source is copied into the new project.

Write a project brief

Write the editable project brief directly.

The Project brief is durable project evidence and direction: what the project should accomplish, verified facts, required content, priorities, and exclusions.

The adjacent Optional AI direction is temporary writing guidance, such as "make this concise," "organize it chronologically," or "preserve every supplied name and date." It is treated as direction rather than verified evidence and is not saved as part of the project. Put project facts in the Project brief.

Use Write with AI to request a draft or improvement. StoryTable returns a suggestion for review; it does not silently replace your brief.

Start with a template

Choose a reusable project Preset. The first screen shows six recommended starting points; choose Browse All Presets... when you need the complete installed collection. Presets appear with thumbnail previews or a deterministic fallback preview. The template supplies starting choices that remain reviewable in the wizard and editable in the project.

When a Template is selected, the next steps begin with that Template's stored Goal, Deliverable, Audience, Channel, Writing Style, Visual Style, Brand, dimensions, orientation, and context defaults. For example, Event Poster Set starts with the source-driven Graphic Set Deliverable, while Classroom Lesson starts with Students in a classroom as its audience and Classroom as its destination. Changing a choice in the wizard creates a project override; it does not silently rewrite the reusable Template.

For a grouped birthday roster, choose Event Poster Set and state the grouping rule in the Project Brief. StoryTable parses the complete source locally, groups students by month and day, and creates the exact source-driven page count before creative generation. Each supplied name and grade is placed exactly once. Groups larger than ten names are divided as evenly as possible across clearly labeled continuation graphics. This roster pagination does not use hosted AI or credits; AI is used only for later creative work such as artwork generation.

Duplicate an existing project

Choose a .story file, project.json, or a StoryTable project folder. StoryTable creates a separate copy rather than editing the selected source project in place.

Step 2: Describe the desired result

Set:

- Project name
- Save location
- Output type

Output choices use visual previews where available.

The save location is the parent folder for the new local project. StoryTable does not overwrite an occupied project folder; it chooses a safe versioned name when necessary.

Step 3: Identify the audience and destination

Describe who should understand or use the result and where they will experience it. These choices shape wording, supporting content, accessibility, discovery, attention, and expected format.

For the included social destinations, the destination actively shapes the build plan. Instagram Feed, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube use separate rules for source selection, openings and endings, image and visible-text density, caption or script responsibilities, safe areas, and writing-style adaptation. A verified publishing limit is treated as a constraint; a suggested card, frame, image, or word count is identified as StoryTable editorial guidance rather than a performance guarantee. Writing Style supplies the voice within those platform rules. Visual Style decorates and unifies the content without choosing the content or increasing its density. Existing social outputs refresh to the current built-in profile when opened.

Templates supply editable starting values for both fields. Changing them for a new project does not alter the reusable Template.

Step 4: Set voice and visual direction

Choose or review:

- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Visual reference images and their intended influence
- Project size

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- Landscape or Portrait orientation
- Whether words appear inside generated images
- Advanced project direction

Library-backed selectors show active items from the selected Library. Saved Library categories appear as disabled dropdown headings; they organize the choices but cannot be selected as values. Removed Library items stay hidden, while unavailable choices already saved inside an existing project remain visible enough for the project to open and be reviewed.

Use Create Brand to create a reusable brand without leaving the wizard. The Brand dialog includes logos, brand imagery, a preview, color swatches, typography, font family, and usage guidance. Color extraction is an explicit Extract Colors from Images action; uploading a logo alone does not indicate that extraction has run.

The words-in-images choices are:

- Automatic: StoryTable shows or hides text in artwork automatically.
- Always: generated artwork should include planned words.
- Never: generated artwork should not contain planned words.

Step 5: Review

Review the complete project setup before creating it. The wizard can also save the selected choices as a reusable Template, including a portable preview.

After creation, StoryTable opens Plan so the source of truth and page outline can be reviewed before generation.

5. All Projects and Overview

All Projects

Use All Projects to:

- Create a new project.
- Open an existing project.
- Open a recent project card.
- Choose Remove on a project card to hide it from StoryTable without deleting its folder or files.

Opening an existing project takes you to Overview.

A removed project can be shown again with Open Project. Select its project folder; opening it restores the project to All Projects and Recent.

Overview

Overview summarizes:

- Project brief
- Source-document count
- Source-image count
- Destination
- Page count
- Current images
- Images needing regeneration

- Locked images
- Failed images
- Blocking issues
- Recent export history

The suggested next action changes with project readiness. For a newly created project with no pages, the meaningful next step is normally in Plan or Generate Page Text.

6. Plan

Plan is where you tell StoryTable what the project means and how each page should work. It writes and edits the outline; it does not generate final images.

One source, multiple outputs

Every project starts with one output. In Plan > 1. Project Setup, choose Another Version... beside Choose What to Make... when the same source material should become another channel or deliverable. Expand Project Setup, then select the channel and deliverable, name the audience and objective, then choose Create Version.

By default, Start with the current page plan and assigned source images is selected. The new output begins with the current pages, words, captions, source-image assignments, and saved source-image analysis. Page dimensions are adapted to the new channel or deliverable, while generated artwork is left empty so StoryTable does not reuse an image made for the wrong dimensions. Clear the option only when the new output should start with no page plan. Project Brief, source documents, source images, and their analysis always remain shared project material. After creation, each output's plan and artwork can be edited independently. Repeat to add further outputs.

Only one named output is shown and edited at a time. Each output keeps its own channel, deliverable, audience, delivery strategy, outline, photo selection, page order, words, captions, artwork, and revision state.

Choose Build Output Plans to rebuild every output's outline in one operation. This replaces existing outlines but does not create artwork. Choose What to Make... shows the selected output's objective and the delivery strategy StoryTable derives from its audience, channel, and deliverable.

Map transcript soundbites to a script or outline

Use Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function when you already know the video's objective, outline, or working script and need exact interview passages placed against it.

1. Select Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function as the Goal and Interview Edit Script as the Deliverable.
2. Put the intended viewer result and ordered outline or script in the Project Brief. Keep the anchor wording and order explicit. If the script is a file, attach it as Background/context so it directs placement but cannot be mistaken for interview speech.
3. Add every quote-bearing transcript and mark each one Interview transcript.
4. Choose Create Page Outline or Update Page Outline. StoryTable reads the included transcripts, verifies candidate wording locally, and maps each selected passage to the anchor where its cinematic or literary function is strongest.
5. In Create & Refine, review the script/outline anchor, story function, verified source, placement rationale, and any functionally distinct alternate soundbites. Review uncovered anchors as reporting or writing gaps rather than accepting a merely topical quotation.
6. In Publish, choose Export Soundbite Map to export the inline map,

source record, alternatives, gaps, and associated editorial handoff files.

Choose Assemble an Interview Edit Script instead when the transcripts should lead StoryTable to discover the controlling idea and construct the narrative arc.

Discover outputs from a source collection

Use the Content Opportunity Finder when you have a collection of source documents, often several transcripts, and want StoryTable to identify useful things the material could become before you choose a format.

1. Start with the Content Opportunity Finder Template.
2. Add the source documents. Mark quote-bearing transcripts as Interview transcript, supporting material as Background/context, and anything StoryTable must ignore as Excluded.
3. Use the Project Brief for any specific audience, campaign priority, constraint, or desired result. The active Library Context supplies the organization's mission, values, audiences, editorial priorities, and sensitivities as a relevance lens; it never supplies missing story facts.
4. Choose Find Content Opportunities. StoryTable reads the complete included source collection and normally proposes three meaningfully different options, with a maximum of five.
5. Review each option's source focus, Template, Goal, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, and short reason. These are setup opportunities, not publishable pages or artwork.
6. Check one or more opportunities and choose Set Up Selected Outputs. Each selection becomes an independent output setup. The Project Brief, source documents, source images, and analysis remain shared. The Router's opportunity cards are not copied into the new outputs, and no output page plan is invented until you review a selected setup and choose to create it. Refreshing the Router later does not change outputs that were already set up.

Find Evergreen Content Angles

Use Evergreen Content Finder to rank source-supported content that can remain useful beyond the current event or news cycle. Its workspace focuses on source material, instructions, feedback, and opportunities.

1. Choose the Evergreen Content Finder Preset, name the Finder, and choose its save location. New-project setup skips visual and page settings.
2. Add documents or transcribe recordings. Review source roles & instructions lets you control inclusion and per-source guidance. Add or review source photos opens the existing source-image analysis and review controls. Analyze and apply image evidence before relying on it for discovery.
3. Optionally use Discovery Brief for the audience, recurring needs, number of angles, time horizon, and likely future uses. Guidance & Feedback collects priorities, exclusions, and revisions to earlier recommendations. Both save automatically. The saved Library context informs relevance and ranking without becoming story evidence.
4. Choose Find Evergreen Opportunities. Review each ranked angle's premise, audience need, shelf life, evidence, reuse suggestions, update-dependent details, and reporting gaps. Weak or unsupported directions appear under Angles Not Recommended. Earlier saved reports remain readable; rerun discovery to obtain selectable cards.
5. Choose Create Project from This Angle to create a separately saved project using the recommended native Preset. Original included sources and their roles, image evidence, and editorial guidance carry forward. The assignment is direction, not an additional source. A proposed outline is built before

artwork. An angle marked Needs additional reporting offers Create Research Project and opens for resolving evidence gaps before generation.

6. Open Project reopens an existing linked project. Return to Evergreen Content

Finder brings you back to the ranked list. Save Opportunity Report exports the findings as a plain-text document without generating artwork.

In Create & Refine, the Page Images card also shows How to use these images. Preserve supplied images requires the photographed people, clothing, and scene to remain unchanged while the surrounding design follows the selected style. Recreate in the selected style redraws the same subjects; Use as inspiration permits new imagery. This is the same saved page choice used in Plan. Changing it keeps existing revisions and marks current artwork for regeneration; it does not immediately regenerate the image.

Find Instagram Post Opportunities

Choose the Instagram Opportunity Desk Preset to map documents, images, or a brief to specific Instagram post concepts. Setup and Plan show two instruction boxes: Instagram Brief and Guidance & Feedback.

- 1.** Add source documents, add or drag images onto Add Images, or simply write a brief. Describe the audience, subject, desired response, preferred formats, writer, and number of ideas. Any combination of these inputs works.
 - 2.** Choose Find Instagram Post Opportunities. New images are analyzed automatically; complete included documents are read before concepts are ranked. Saved Library context shapes relevance and the selected voice shapes the writer.
 - 3.** Review each concept's format, truthful hook, and reason people might share or save it. Expand Review Sequence, Evidence & Asset Needs for its ordered progression, source evidence, caption direction, and missing inputs. Formats include carousels, single-image posts, and Reel storyboards. Creative patterns are matched to the subject: for example, a useful checklist, a visual reveal, an exact quote with insight, a micro-story, or a supported reframe.
 - 4.** Choose Create This Project, or check several concepts and choose Create Selected Projects. Each receives its own project folder, source copies, selected images, audience, writing voice, and saved guidance. Ready concepts receive post drafts; concepts marked Needs additional inputs receive an assignment to resolve before generation. A failure in one draft preserves the other created projects.
 - 5.** Open Project reopens a linked project without creating a duplicate.
- Return to Instagram Opportunity Desk returns to the recommendations. Bulk creation returns to the desk, where the individual projects can be opened. Add feedback and find opportunities again to refine the options.

"Viral" describes potential share/save appeal, not guaranteed performance. StoryTable does not claim live trend or account analytics. A brief-led concept does not turn user assertions into verified source facts. Reel outputs are production storyboards with scene direction and script, not rendered videos.

Run an Event Editorial Desk

Use the Event Editorial Desk Preset when several festival, conference, academy, or event transcripts should become a menu of magazine-style stories. It activates the Run an Event Editorial Desk Goal and gives that project its own Plan workspace instead of making you use unrelated page and artwork fields.

- 1.** Start with the Event Editorial Desk Preset. Name the desk, choose its save location, and optionally enter the Coverage Brief and Editorial Guidance & Feedback. Desk setup skips audience/channel and visual settings; selected stories get their own complete project setup later.

2. Under Event transcripts, choose Add Transcript Files... for completed transcripts or Transcribe a Recording... for an audio or video session. Add the complete transcript from every program the desk should compare. At least one complete, readable transcript is required before analysis can begin.
3. Coverage Brief is optional. Use it to identify the publication and reader, the event or date range, the value the coverage should provide, priorities, sensitivities, and any topics or voices to include or avoid. Choose Help Me Shape the Brief when you want an AI-supported draft to review and edit. Use Editorial Guidance & Feedback for additional context, exclusions, or feedback on the proposed stories. Both instruction boxes save automatically. Revise them and analyze again to apply your feedback. Review sources & instructions lets you inspect source roles, edit per-source guidance, and remove files without opening page-planning controls.
4. Review the requirements callout beside the Analyze action. StoryTable creates each assignment's working headline, source focus, evidence reason, and other assignment details; you do not have to enter those fields yourself. Choose Find Story Opportunities. StoryTable reads the included transcript collection and displays supported assignments in two groups: Stories from one session and Stories across the event. If the sources cannot support one group, the desk says so instead of inventing an angle.
5. Review each card's working headline, reader promise, editorial angle, named source programs, evidence signal, and suggested Goal and Preset.
6. Choose Create Story Project on one card. StoryTable preserves the desk and creates and opens a separately saved StoryTable project for that assignment. The new project uses the suggested native Goal, Template, Deliverable, and Channel. It carries forward the approved assignment, its named source programs and evidence, relevant context documents, source images, Brand, Visual Style, palette, typography, and visual references. If the assignment already has a project, its card says Open Story Project and reopens the same project instead of creating a duplicate. The saved desk audience and audience corrections also carry into the story's Audience and Adjust Audience interpretation fields. The story recalculates its interpretation for its own destination; later audience edits apply to that story independently. Older commissioned projects still showing an untouched Template audience are repaired when opened if their saved desk or audience snapshot is available. Existing audience refinements are preserved.
7. StoryTable builds a proposed page outline and opens the normal Plan workspace before artwork is generated. Review and edit the Project Brief, Goal, Deliverable, audience, style, imagery, layout, and every planned page. Then use Create & Refine to generate, review, and revise the designed pages. Article Page Text is the finished reader-facing article. The selected Writing Style acts as its writer, shaping perspective, emphasis, lead, sequence, pacing, and ending within the assignment and verified evidence. Editorial analysis, fact checks, and approval tasks stay in working notes. In Create & Refine, the Page Images panel lets you Add Images to This Page... or Choose Project Images... before generating artwork. You can also drag one or several PNG, JPG, or WebP files onto this panel or the main image preview. StoryTable copies them into the project and attaches them to the selected page, keeping the original files in place. Dropping the same files again reuses their existing project records. Attached thumbnails show the images assigned to that page. Removing an assignment keeps the original file in the project's image collection.
8. Use Another Version... under Story Versions when the story also needs a different platform, format, or audience treatment. Each version remains in the commissioned story project and can have its own page setup and artwork. Choose Return to Event Editorial Desk to reopen the parent opportunity list and commission another story without rerunning the analysis.

When a saved transcript-analysis catalog is available, the commissioned project receives a focused evidence packet containing the relevant findings and exact soundbites with their speakers and locators. The matching complete transcripts remain attached as verification copies. If that catalog is unavailable, the named transcripts remain active so StoryTable can analyze the required evidence while it builds the outline.

StoryTable saves completed transcript analysis before it assembles the final assignment desk. The final synthesis can

use the selected model's full supported output allowance, including its reasoning, and StoryTable automatically retries one confirmed hosted length-limit failure with more concise desk instructions. That retry reuses the saved transcript catalog; it does not resend completed transcript sections. If the desk still cannot finish, the existing project and any previous desk remain unchanged.

If hosted synthesis completes but StoryTable is interrupted before applying the desk, run the same unchanged Find Story Opportunities action. The saved task is checked and its completed result is applied without starting or charging for another generation. Keep the transcript collection, Coverage Brief, and generation settings unchanged until recovery finishes so StoryTable can identify the original request.

The Event Editorial Desk is narrower than Content Opportunity Finder. The Desk commissions magazine-style article ideas from an event transcript collection, then turns each chosen assignment into its own complete StoryTable project. Content Opportunity Finder routes a broader source collection into several independent output setups and formats inside the current project.

Project brief

The project brief is the editable source of truth. Put confirmed facts, chronology, required messages, goals, exclusions, and other story-wide direction here.

Supporting files remain separate. A source document's purpose and notes help StoryTable understand its role, but do not automatically make every statement in that document a verified fact.

Source documents

Choose Add Documents to attach project evidence and context. Plan accepts:

- TXT
- Markdown
- SRT subtitles and transcripts
- text-based PDF
- DOCX
- CSV
- HTML or HTM
- ICS, ICAL, IFB, or VCS calendar files

The table records each document, its Purpose, instructions for How StoryTable should use it, and document actions. Files are copied into the project. Use Interview transcript for each interview that may supply exact quotes. Every included interview is considered as a peer; this does not require equal screen time. Primary source identifies one lead document when that is appropriate. Importing multiple timed transcripts together assigns them the Interview transcript role automatically; check the role for untimed text.

Background/context and Writing Style reference can guide planning but cannot supply soundbites. Excluded prevents a document from entering planning or quote searches. Changing a formerly primary document to another role clears its obsolete primary assignment. A CSV, DOCX, HTML, or calendar file may also serve as the primary document.

What each Purpose means

- Interview transcript reads the full interview in transcript-specific workflows and permits exact, source-verified soundbites.
- Supporting source supplies secondary evidence and context. It is not the lead document and does not activate transcript analysis by its label alone.
- Event details identifies names, dates, program titles, schedules, and

logistics. The label guides interpretation; it is not a separate event-data or fact-checking engine.

- Background and context informs planning but is blocked from soundbite searches. Use it for outlines, scripts, research, schedules, and material that must not be represented as interview speech.
- Quotes and testimonials identifies approved proof or a quote bank. Use Interview transcript instead when exact transcript provenance is required.
- Dates and fact checking identifies the reference StoryTable should consult for names, dates, figures, and specifications. It does not independently prove that every statement in the file is correct.
- Writing Style reference guides tone, cadence, structure, and technique. Its subjects and claims are not treated as story evidence.
- Primary source makes one document the lead source in ordinary planning. Choosing another Primary automatically demotes the previous one to Supporting.
- A transcript collection does not require a Primary source. You may mark every interview file Interview transcript so StoryTable considers them as peers.
- Excluded keeps the copied file attached but removes it from source context, transcript analysis, and quote search until it is assigned another purpose.

The Purpose menu is editable, but custom wording does not create a new processing rule. Use one of the built-in purposes for dependable inclusion and quotation behavior, then use How StoryTable should use it for the specific nuance. Changing a Purpose or its instructions affects the next outline, analysis, or AI writing action; it does not silently rewrite work that was already saved.

Use the instruction column to describe evidence boundaries, not merely the desired prose. Useful examples include:

Treat this as current-year evidence. Do not reuse comments identified as last year.

Quotes must be verbatim and attributed to the named speaker. Use the event description only as context, not as quotation text.

This document is background only. Do not infer dates or identities that are not stated in a primary transcript.

Transcribe a recording

Choose Transcribe Recording... in Source Documents and select a supported audio or video file. StoryTable prepares the audio, detects speakers, preserves timestamps, and writes a speaker-labeled SRT into the project. In interview projects, successive recordings remain Interview transcript peers instead of replacing one another as the primary source. Long recordings are divided into safe request-sized parts and reassembled into one continuous transcript.

After transcription, Name Speakers... lets you replace detected labels such as Speaker 1 with real names in the latest transcribed recording. StoryTable updates that recording's SRT, saved evidence and related quote components, without renaming a different interview that happens to use the same detected label. Review uncertain speaker turns before using them publicly.

Transcription is a hosted action. You must be signed in, and FFmpeg must be available in the packaged app or local installation. The original recording is retained as project evidence; the editable transcript is the SRT copy.

Choose Create Page Outline or Update Page Outline after the brief or supporting evidence changes. Review the

resulting outline before generating images.

Complete interview analysis and progress

Interview Edit Script projects, sources marked Interview transcript, and timed transcript projects use a complete-source analysis stage before story assembly. Every included transcript is read in full and analyzed in bounded sections; long files are not reduced to an initial excerpt. StoryTable keeps each section's findings and exact quote candidates, then compares the evidence across interviews to build the plan.

StoryTable measures the extracted text and serialized request directly. A transcript stays in one analysis section when it fits the safe section budget; larger transcripts are divided without mixing their source identity. Every finished section is checkpointed. The final step reads the saved, source-organized catalog rather than resending completed transcript sections. If that catalog is too large for one planning context, StoryTable selects evidence through smaller, cached batches before assembling the final context.

Exact-quote checking is intentionally non-blocking at this preliminary stage. If AI proposes a candidate whose speaker, words, or time range cannot be verified against the transcript, StoryTable excludes that candidate, records the exclusion in the coverage files, and continues with the verified findings and soundbites. One optional bad quote must not abort the project outline.

The progress display names the source and section being processed. Final story assembly shows a waiting indicator rather than a misleading completed count. You can pause or cancel. Completed analysis sections are saved for retry; a changed source, purpose or instruction is rechecked before cached work is used. Cancellation or an analysis failure preserves the existing plan and images. Unreadable, malformed or incomplete included sources are identified for repair. The Event Editorial Desk also reuses this complete saved analysis when only its final set of story assignments needs to be regenerated.

In Files, look under Story Data for book/transcript-analysis/. The coverage report, complete catalog and planning context show which sources and sections were processed. Coverage confirms that the material was processed; review is still needed for the interpretation and editorial choices.

Source Images

Source Images are images StoryTable can read as evidence, not merely pictures to imitate.

1. Choose Add Images.
2. Select one or more PNG, JPEG, or WebP files.
3. Choose Analyze Selected or Analyze Unread.
4. Review what StoryTable found.

Large readable source images are accepted and normalized to a bounded working copy inside the project; StoryTable retains the original filename and digest as provenance. In a multi-file selection, one unreadable image no longer cancels the valid imports. StoryTable adds every readable file and identifies any skipped filenames and reasons.

Choose Select All Images to select the complete source-image list. Choose Remove All Selected... to remove the selected unused images and their saved analysis in one confirmed operation. Removal is all-or-nothing: if any selected image is still assigned to an output page, no selected image is removed.

When choosing Add Existing Images for a page, the source-image picker shows Assigned to Page... or Not assigned to a page beneath every photo. Selecting an item displays a larger preview beside the list. Choose View Full Size..., double-click the list item, or double-click the larger preview for the full-size StoryTable viewer. Existing assignments do not prevent assigning one source image to another page.

The review area contains:

- Visible text

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- Interpretation
- Suggested caption
- Key facts
- Uncertainties
- Page and caption instructions

Suggested caption is StoryTable's editable AI analysis; it is not the caption embedded in the original file. StoryTable separately reads supported embedded Description/caption/comment fields and Creator/artist fields from PNG, JPEG, and WebP metadata.

Each writing field can use Write with AI. Give a specific instruction such as:

Write a short past-tense caption using the event name, date, and listed activities. Describe what happened rather than inviting the reader to attend.

StoryTable saves source-image review edits automatically after a short pause. Save Now is also available. A save failure keeps the edits visible and prevents navigation away until the problem is resolved.

The Page Images panel also has Analyze Selected and Analyze All beside the page-image list. These actions analyze the visible attachments in place and save the same transcription, interpretation, facts, caption, and uncertainty fields to their shared Source Images records. Analyze All asks before replacing analysis that has already been reviewed.

For a multi-page photo sequence, select the source photos and choose Build Photo Story.... Photo density is the maximum number of selected photos that may appear on one page. When Target pages/cards is Auto and Use every selected image is checked, StoryTable expands an ordinary presentation or document to however many pages that density requires. A real publishing cap for one platform-native output, such as one social carousel, remains a hard limit; StoryTable identifies that exact limit instead of replacing it with a generic failure message.

Use Page Text source to decide what StoryTable places in the on-screen Page Text field for the proposed outline:

- AI-written from all reviewed evidence uses metadata, visible text, reviewed visual analysis, source facts, and project direction.

- Embedded caption: verbatim copies the original file's

Description/caption/comment wording without an AI rewrite. On a grouped page, distinct captions appear in source-image order; repeats appear once.

- Embedded caption: adapt to Writing Style may reshape only the embedded caption in the selected Writing Style. It cannot introduce facts. If an adaptation is unsupported, StoryTable keeps the embedded wording instead.

The two embedded-caption modes leave body Page Text blank when an assigned photo has no embedded caption; StoryTable does not substitute its Suggested caption. Enable Add photographer credit to on-screen Page Text to append Photo: Name or Photos: Name · Name from embedded Creator/artist metadata. Missing creator metadata adds no invented credit. These are Page Text controls: the project's Words inside images setting still determines whether Page Text is rendered visibly in the generated artwork.

If the project has source images but no transcript or source document, the main Build Project Outline action automatically follows this same photo-story route. The optional batch-instructions field may be blank. StoryTable uses the complete source-image collection, analyzes any unread files, and shows the proposed page groups before changing the outline; it does not demand a text source for an image-led slideshow.

Choose the creative effect

For the selected source image, use How should this image shape the story and artwork?

- Save for later - no creative effect yet stores the analysis without adding it to the brief, outline, or artwork.
- Inform the whole story - add its analysis to the Project Brief adds the reviewed meaning and facts to the story-wide brief.
- Make it its own page - write and illustrate a page from it creates one dedicated page using the reviewed copy and the original image as-is in a styled layout.
- Shape Page N only adds the reviewed context to one existing page and attaches the original for as-is use.

For as-is use, StoryTable may crop, mask, frame, and style around the supplied image, but it must not redraw or replace the people or content in that image. Use-as-is applies to the supplied photo, not to the surrounding page design: selected backgrounds, architectural references, paper textures, frames, typography, and brand colors still apply. Instructions assigning a reference as an accurate real space remain authoritative; StoryTable must not substitute an invented space. When all page and design references exceed the upload limit, StoryTable packs references into labeled sheets while retaining every source and its assigned role. Individual panels may be resized to fit these sheets.

In generated page artwork, frames belong only around actual foreground images when the selected style calls for frames. Each frame hugs its image's bounds and follows its aspect ratio. Backgrounds, unused layout slots, text, and logos do not receive photo frames. A style without frames does not acquire them. Separate frame PNGs remain available through Create Slide Assets for you to place manually.

For pages with assigned images and a resolved layout, StoryTable prepares the occupied image regions for generation. Unused photo slots and the raw layout guide are omitted from the AI request; the saved layout remains unchanged. Text, backgrounds, Brand elements, and negative space retain their roles. Freeform or ambiguous layouts keep their arrangement. When no foreground photos remain, samples saved solely to guide photo borders are omitted from the request. Paper, typography, and mixed-purpose references remain available for their other roles.

For imported PDF pages, StoryTable checks older extracted images that still carry the default photograph role, across all supplied-image treatments and text settings. Confirmed text-led graphics with no real photographic content are treated as source graphics rather than photographs and do not receive photo frames. With Recreate the same image in the selected style, an assigned title graphic remains required content: its message, hierarchy, and internal composition guide the new artwork. A style or background sample cannot replace that graphic with its own subject. As-is preserves the graphic when text is enabled; for text-free as-is artwork it becomes source content/design evidence. Inspiration permits reinterpretation. The current text-in-art setting controls lettering. Actual photos, photographed signs or artwork, graphics containing real photos, and uncertain cases keep their applicable treatment.

The initial reading may use AI; later runs can reuse its classification and wording while the file and analysis settings match. Source files and saved assignments remain unchanged. Review the generated result to confirm its composition and source fidelity. After updating StoryTable, regenerate affected artwork to use this preparation; existing images do not change automatically.

Turn several source images into pages

Use the batch source-image page action when each selected image should become its own page. Enter shared page and caption instructions before creating the pages.

The operation continues past images that cannot be applied. It reports and skips images that have not been analyzed or already have a dedicated source-image page instead of stopping the entire batch.

Project direction

Project direction includes:

- Project template
- Goal

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- Deliverable
- Audience
- Channel or destination
- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Project size
- Landscape or Portrait orientation
- Words inside images
- Additional writing and image instructions

Library selections are captured into the project. Editing the original Library item later does not silently change an existing project's saved direction.

Plan begins with six broad Goals: repurpose existing material, teach or explain, guide a process, create information graphics, tell or recap a story, and promote or persuade. Select More Goals to expand specialized or custom Goal cards. The Presets area initially shows the three Presets that directly match the selected Goal; Browse All Presets... reveals the rest of the installed collection. Goals and Presets use visual cards that show the transformation or starting workflow at a glance.

Visual Styles are organized by category so you can narrow the card grid before choosing a look. Each card uses a short, readable summary for browsing. The complete saved Visual Style description and reference-image direction remain attached to the style and are still used when StoryTable creates artwork; the card summary does not shorten or replace those generation instructions.

Project Characters

Add recurring Characters from the Character Library. Character cards include thumbnails where available.

- Add to Project captures the selected Character in the current project.
- Update from Library refreshes that project's saved Character snapshot.
- Remove from Project removes it from this project's cast without deleting the Character from Libraries.

Typography

Set font family, typography rules, a typography reference image, and guidance. Typography is live project direction; it does not require text to be painted into generated artwork.

Page Outline

The Page Outline controls the ordered pages. The left side lists Pages and supports drag ordering. Right-click a page to save, analyze, rebuild, create artwork, duplicate, reorder, or delete it.

Available actions include:

- Add Page
- Duplicate Page
- Delete Page
- Import PDF as Pages
- Create or Update Page Outline
- Save Page
- Save Project Plan

Choose Duplicate Page beside Add Page to copy the selected page directly after it. StoryTable saves pending page edits first, then copies the page text, settings, layout, reference assignments, transcript evidence, current artwork, and complete image revision history. The copy has its own editable page and artwork history, so later changes do not overwrite the original. Duplication uses no AI generation and starts the new page unlocked.

For the selected page, review or edit:

- Page Text and Caption, grouped in Page Content
- Page Images and Characters, grouped in Page Content
- Verified transcript evidence, speaker name, transcript filename, and time range for every soundbite or splice component
- Page Art Direction, including Layout and placement direction
- Page Type and Content Type
- Alt Text and the Include Brand Logo choice
- Deliverable-specific details, such as lyric, motion, or event-poster fields

Use Write Caption with AI to draft a caption and Copy to copy it. Publication captions autosave after a short pause.

Page Text and image-only PDF wording

An imported label such as "Page 3 from source PDF." is not presentation copy. New PDF pages without a readable text layer leave Page Text empty until source wording is available. For older imported placeholders, generation uses extracted text blocks first, then reads the visible headline and body wording from the current assigned page images when needed. It preserves the source language and wording rather than inventing a generic title. The complete PDF page is a fallback only when no page images are assigned. Recovered wording is saved into editable Page Text during image-generation preparation so you can review and revise the actual words. This happens only while the saved field is an unextracted blank or the exact importer placeholder; newer edits and changed image assignments are checked before saving. Repeated generation can reuse the source reading, and user-written Page Text takes precedence.

To remove page copy, clear Page Text and save. A deliberately cleared field stays empty after saving and reopening; StoryTable does not refill it from old copy or source analysis. Typing new words replaces that choice. Leaving a newly imported empty field untouched still allows missing source wording to be read. Text in Generated Artwork separately controls whether lettering is included in generated pixels. Review any words already embedded in a supplied as-is image under that setting.

Replace a quote without losing transcript grounding

For pages built around an interview quotation, Find Another Soundbite... is located directly with Page Text. It is different from Regenerate Text:

- Find Another Soundbite... searches every quote-eligible transcript, excludes the current quote and soundbites already used elsewhere, and returns only a candidate that StoryTable can verify locally against the source words.
- Regenerate Text writes new page copy in the selected Writing Style. It is not the correct action when the result must remain a verbatim quotation.

Describe the editorial job of the replacement, including exclusions. For example:

Find a current-year student quote about feeling welcomed. Do not use this speaker, last-year references, or a paraphrase. Prefer a specific lived moment over a general claim.

The review dialog shows the proposed exact words, speaker name, transcript filename, in/out time, and whether the

result is one continuous excerpt or an explicitly marked same-speaker splice. Each splice component has its own speaker and transcript attribution. Plan, Create, Refine and edit-script views also display this attribution; unavailable metadata is labeled Unknown speaker or Unknown transcript instead of being guessed. Nothing changes until you accept it. If no eligible exact match exists, StoryTable should report that it found none rather than inventing one.

The Transcript Evidence section appears when the project includes a transcript and stores the editable evidence record. Keep Page Text, Caption, and exact transcript evidence in their separate fields. For an ordinary transcript-based story, transcript evidence is supporting provenance rather than the output itself. If one proposed excerpt cannot be verified word for word, StoryTable omits only that excerpt and continues saving the completed output plan. A page with no remaining verified excerpt keeps its Page Text and publication caption and leaves the evidence field empty. An Interview Edit Script remains stricter because its exact soundbites are the deliverable.

Supplied images on a page

Each page can have supplied photographs or reference images. Choose the treatment deliberately:

- Use supplied image faithfully in one AI-designed composition
- Recreate the same image in the selected style
- Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style

This distinction is preserved when images are generated. As-is sends the original source and design references together to the image provider for one unified composition. StoryTable instructs the provider to include the supplied asset once without redrawing, duplicating, or replacing it; it does not create a local backing plate or paste the source on afterward. It requests the provider's high input-fidelity mode for this treatment. Use it for photographs, screenshots, documents, readable signs, diagrams, exact likeness, or any source whose visible content must remain intact, and review the provider result for fidelity. Recreate sends the source to the image model and preserves its subjects, setting, composition, viewpoint, and important details while rendering a new image in the selected style. Inspiration permits a new composition and may change or omit people, objects, wording, setting, and viewpoint. Existing project data that formerly used faithful redraw opens as Recreate the same image in the selected style rather than silently changing to inspiration.

What saves automatically in Plan

The following use a short delayed autosave:

- Source-image review fields and per-image instructions
- Captions
- Page Layout selection and layout direction

Other page fields use Save Page. Story-wide Plan changes use Save Project Plan or the header Save.

7. Create

When a project has multiple outputs, Create Artwork for All Outputs appears. It quotes the combined image scope before submission, completes one named output at a time, and then returns to the output you were editing. The ordinary Missing, Selected, and All actions remain scoped to the current output.

Create submits page-writing, image-generation, and reusable-design-asset work.

Generation actions

- Generate Pages and Images creates the page plan and image work in one guided operation.
- Generate Page Text generates or updates page text without generating all images.
- Create Missing Images generates only pages that currently need an image.

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- Create Selected Images uses the checked pages.
- Create All Images submits all eligible pages.
- Generate Asset Collection creates a new reusable design system for the current presentation canvas, using the project style or another installed Visual Style.
- Create Social Assets creates platform-ready reusable design elements for selected social formats.

Before image work, StoryTable shows the scope, actionable page count, cost estimate, and notes. Review this preflight before continuing.

Image estimates separate one attempt per actionable image from the maximum allowance if every permitted retry is needed. The retry allowance is a ceiling, not the expected bill. Reused source readings and prompt preparation may avoid repeat work; the final usage depends on the work actually performed.

Page selection and status

The page list shows the status of every page. Checkboxes define Create Selected Images.

The selected-page action uses status-consistent wording:

- Create Image when no current image exists.
- Recreate Image when the current image needs regeneration.

Locked pages are always skipped by generation actions.

Skip, include, and remove

- Skip Image excludes the page from Create Missing, Selected, and All.
- Include Image makes a skipped page eligible again.
- Remove Current Image removes the active image while retaining prior revisions for possible restoration.
- Remove Legacy Text Overlay removes an old live-text overlay without using AI.

Image work can finish with a mix of successful, skipped, and failed pages. Review each page status rather than assuming a 100% operation bar means every page produced a new image.

Generate an asset collection

The entry button establishes the workflow, so the dialog does not ask you to choose Slide versus Social a second time.

For both workflows, choose Visual style first:

- Use project style uses the visual-style snapshot saved with the project and may use representative current accepted artwork as visual evidence.
- Choosing an installed Visual Style makes that style authoritative for this asset request. StoryTable keeps the current project brand, typography, content, and compatible guidance, but excludes accepted artwork and project visual references made under the prior style.

Generate Asset Collection uses the current project's slide canvas. Choose the reusable asset role and quantity, then optionally provide overall and per-variation design direction. This is the broad asset-authoring workflow: it can follow the project style or deliberately use another installed Visual Style. To package assets that already belong to the open project, use Export Project Assets in Export instead.

The slide kit separates the background surface from the pieces you arrange on top:

- 01_backgrounds contains fully opaque PNG backgrounds at the active project canvas size. The default landscape canvas is 3840 x 2160 pixels; a portrait project keeps its portrait canvas. The background carries the selected visual medium and substrate. For a charcoal-on-paper style, charcoal drawing and paper are the foundation. Frames,

callout panels, decorative flourishes, and complete slide layouts belong in other files.

- 02_frames contains separate landscape, portrait, and square PNG frames. Both the area outside each frame and its empty image opening are transparent. Place your own image behind the frame so it remains visible through the opening.
- 03_text_backings contains title, caption, lower-third, and body-copy surfaces. The surface behind your text is opaque, with transparency around its designed edges. Add your own editable text on top.
- 04_callouts contains reusable panels, labels, badges, and annotation pieces. Text-bearing panels have opaque interiors and transparent surroundings; arrows and pointers retain transparency wherever nothing is drawn.
- 05_graphics_and_accents contains separate symbols, strokes, rules, flourishes, and other decorative PNGs with transparent backgrounds.

Before generation, preflight lists the asset types that will be created and the standard types that are absent from the request. StoryTable creates a category folder only when that category has an exported asset or sidecar file. An absent category, or a category whose generation fails without producing a usable file, does not leave an empty folder in the asset export.

Use these files to arrange your own templates and presets in Google Slides, Canva, PowerPoint, or another design tool. The selected style determines their shared drawing, material, and color treatment; it does not combine them into one fixed composition.

When a completed opaque background and usable pieces are available, 06_examples includes flattened composition guides made from those exact exported PNGs. The examples introduce no extra generated imagery, text, or sample photos and require no additional AI generation charge. Frame openings show the actual background underneath. You can follow a guide or arrange every piece differently. Each guide has a companion layout file recording its source files and placements. A guide demonstrates available pieces; it does not mean every requested asset succeeded.

Create Social Assets uses a platform-oriented Asset kit, such as Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, LinkedIn, TikTok, X, Pinterest, or Cross-platform essentials. The selected platform reveals its applicable formats and exact dimensions. Choose:

- the platform kit;
- one or more included formats;
- the specific reusable Asset role;
- variations per format; and
- optional overall or per-variation design direction.

The summary shows the exact file multiplier before the cost preflight. Each format is designed independently for its target canvas and safe-area guidance. StoryTable does not crop one master design into every ratio. The generated manifest records the platform, placement, dimensions, selected style, safe-zone guidance, and specification sources.

8. Create & Refine

Create & Refine is for page-by-page creation, review, and controlled revision. At the top of Art Direction, Text in Artwork offers three explicit project-level choices: Automatic: decide per page, Include Page Text in artwork, and Keep Page Text outside artwork. The explanatory line beneath the control shows the selected page's resolved behavior in Automatic mode. Changing this setting does not delete Page Text or Caption copy.

Edit text and captions

- Edit Page Text, then choose Save Text.
- Edit the publication caption; it autosaves after a short pause.
- Use Write Caption with AI for a reviewed suggestion.
- Use Copy to place the active caption on the clipboard.

Revise an image

1. Select the page.
2. Enter revision notes.
3. Choose Regenerate Image.
4. Review the resulting current version and status.

StoryTable creates a new revision rather than overwriting the prior generated version.

Version history

The Version history panel supports:

- Compare
- Restore Selected

Restoring a version makes it current without destroying the other recorded revisions.

Lock an accepted image

Lock an image when it must not be regenerated or replaced. A lock protects that page from:

- Regeneration
- Replacement
- Removal of the current image
- Bulk image generation

Unlock the image explicitly before changing it.

Skip or remove

Skip Image temporarily excludes the page from image batches. Remove Current Image removes only the active image reference; retained revisions remain available in history.

9. Publish

Export begins with a centered Project Preview and an Export Tools card grid. Choose Export Project, Finish in Claude Design, Caption, Export Project Assets, Export History, or Batch Projects to open that tool in the central settings area. For a multi-output project, the primary action becomes Export All Outputs. StoryTable creates one package per target plus a master folder and ZIP. The scope determines whether to use only completed images or retained saved versions. Missing or unverified files cannot be exported. Ordinary publication packaging does not generate artwork. Claude Design handoff and matching project-asset creation are separate, explicit choices with generation estimates before any required image work.

Publish creates a verified, shareable package from current page images and captions.

For an Editorial Text Document, Publish hides the image preview, Caption, Claude Design, and project-asset tools. Export Scope becomes document sections, and Export Text Document writes editable Markdown and plain text rather than an image publication package.

Choose the scope

- All completed page images includes pages whose images match their saved generation state.
- Current page only uses the selected completed page.
- Selected page numbers uses the entered page range under the normal completion checks.

- All saved page images includes every retained accepted image on disk, even when the page says Needs Image Regeneration or a later attempt failed.

Choose All saved page images to export the finished versions already in your project without regenerating them.

Review identifies saved images that may not reflect the latest settings. Missing, uncommitted or changed image files still fail verification. This scope works for publication packages, Claude Design handoffs and multi-output packages; it does not change page status, locks or image history.

Choose caption behavior

- A separate caption for each page shows how many planned pages already have captions and opens the page-level Caption editor for review.
- One caption for the complete post or sequence provides one shared Caption field for the active output.

Choose Caption format first. The visible instructions and controls then match that choice. Use Write Caption with AI in shared mode or Review Page Captions in per-page mode. Captions are optional: leaving the selected caption fields blank exports the artwork and other available handoff files without a captions.txt file.

Review before export

Set:

- Destination folder
- Optional package name
- Export scope
- Caption mode

Review the package preview and scope. Use All saved page images when you want retained accepted versions despite newer settings or a failed later attempt. Relink missing images and resolve version or file-verification errors before exporting.

Publication package contents

Export Publication Package creates both a folder and ZIP containing:

- publication.pdf - ordered visual review with selectable caption text
- images/ - numbered full-resolution current images in publication order
- captions.txt - one text file for the active caption setup
- publish.csv - image order, captions, destination, and size data
- manifest.json - package metadata and file checksums
- README.txt - handoff instructions
- an offline HTML preview for browsing the package locally when included by the current export service

The PDF is a convenient review and copy/paste handoff. The separate files in images/ are the publication-ready originals. The offline HTML preview is a local package file that travels with its companion files; it is not automatically hosted on the web. Packaging copies current images without resizing or reformatting them and does not change the project.

Export history appears on the Publish screen.

Export Project Assets

Open Export Project Assets to see the separate reusable PNG components that currently belong to the open project's visual contract. Backgrounds, frames, text panels, callouts, and accents each appear as a visual inventory card with a real thumbnail and count when available. Existing assets are included automatically.

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Use Add matching on an asset card when you need more of that type. New variations remain locked to the project's saved Visual Style, Brand, typography, visual references, and representative accepted artwork, so there is no second style selector or general design brief to manage in Export. StoryTable shows the number of existing and newly requested PNGs before you continue. AI preflight and cost approval appear only when you request new assets.

The export creates a folder and ZIP with a manifest and README. It creates only the category folders that contain real files; empty asset types are reported and skipped. Elements baked into a finished page image cannot be recovered as separate layers. Use Generate Asset Collection in Create when you want to invent a broader collection from a chosen Visual Style rather than package the open project's assets. StoryTable no longer offers a separate Canva Design Kit export of flattened page images.

Finish in Claude Design

Use Export for Claude Design when StoryTable should create all page imagery and Claude Design should finish the layout with live, editable text. Choose the scope and destination, export the ZIP, and then choose Import or Upload in Claude Design. Select the complete ZIP. This workflow does not require MCP, Claude Code, or a local connection between StoryTable and Claude Desktop.

Every exported page image is text-free. If a selected StoryTable image already contains presentation lettering, StoryTable offers to create a separate text-free export copy. Review the image count and estimated cost before that work begins. The copy is stored outside the accepted page revision and reused while its source image remains current. The finished page, lock state, settings and image history do not change.

The folder and ZIP contain:

- 01 TEXT-FREE ARTWORK/ with the completed StoryTable-created imagery
- 02 EDITABLE TEXT AND PAGE PLAN/page_plan.md with exact live copy and each page's saved typography and placement direction
- project_and_brand_context.md with the brief, audience, output goal, Library context, Brand rules and Visual Style snapshot
- 03 ORIGINAL SOURCES/ with the project-local source files
- 04 BRAND AND VISUAL REFERENCES/ with the project-local reference stack
- 00 PASTE INTO CLAUDE DESIGN.txt with the governing assembly request
- manifest.json with file hashes, page lineage and the text-free handoff contract

If Claude Design does not begin from the package automatically, open 00 START HERE - CLAUDE DESIGN.md and follow its short instructions, then paste 00 PASTE INTO CLAUDE DESIGN.txt. The request tells Claude Design to keep the StoryTable imagery intact, add exact_live_text as live text, translate saved hierarchy markers into text styles, and follow the page-level layout and typography directions. Review the first draft against page_plan.md before making local edits in Claude Design.

10. Files

Files is a read-only inventory of files stored with the current project. It does not move project files into a shared Library.

Actions

- Refresh
- Open File
- Show in Folder
- Open Project Folder

Reusable-asset creation lives on Create, alongside the other AI creation actions. Generated asset files remain inside

the current project and appear in this Files inventory.

Filter and inspect

Filter by type or search by name. The table shows:

- File
- Type
- Size
- Page
- Location

File categories include generated pages and data, page and project references, source documents, source images, exports, StoryTable data, prompts, logs, and other project assets.

Select an image file to preview it. Double-click a file to open it with the operating system's associated application.

11. Libraries

Libraries is the reusable-asset workspace. It replaces the disconnected Classic UI library tabs with one type-aware screen.

Asset types

StoryTable has ten reusable Library types:

1. Template
2. Goal
3. Instruction Assistant
4. Deliverable
5. Channel
6. Writing Style
7. Brand
8. Visual Style
9. Layout
10. Character

Understand the Type menu and left navigation

The Type menu controls both the main stage and the left navigation.

All Types

When All Types is selected:

- The left navigation lists asset types with counts.
- The main stage groups cards by asset type.
- Selecting a type on the left opens that type and its applicable filters.
- New Asset asks which asset type to create.

One selected type

When a specific type is selected, the left navigation changes to:

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- All items of that type
- StoryTable
- My Library
- Removed
- Folders
- Unfiled
- User-created folders for that type

The filters apply only to the selected asset type. A Visual Style folder, for example, is not shown as a Character filter.

Use Search to narrow the currently filtered results.

Consistent asset controls

The top action row provides:

- New Type
- Edit or Customize
- Duplicate
- Remove
- Restore
- Move to Folder
- Use in Project

Templates use Start New Project instead of Use in Project.

The Transfer row provides:

- Import Type
- Export Selected Type
- Export Library
- Import Library

Every reusable type can be transferred: Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, and Character. StoryTable-supplied items can also be exported; an included Template is imported as an editable custom copy instead of replacing the included original.

StoryTable-supplied read-only items use Customize to create an editable user version. Remove is reversible; use the Removed filter and Restore to recover the item.

Six-Slide Pitch

Use Six-Slide Pitch to introduce any product or service to a specific client. It uses Promote or Persuade and creates one presentation with exactly six slides and a complete spoken pitch in the speaker notes.

1. Start a new project from Six-Slide Pitch.
2. In Six-slide pitch, enter the Client type, Product information,

and Customer outcome. Describe the customer starting point and why the result matters. Product information can include your product name, supported capabilities, facts, and proof; attach supporting sources when useful.

3. Choose Pitch delivery format: presentation slides, PowerPoint, or PDF.

This choice shapes the writing for presenting or reading. The customer outcome is the result you are selling, such as a schedule ready to send; delivery format is how you will share this pitch.

4. Shape Your pitch and Call to action. Request exact wording explicitly

where needed. These fields remain editable in Plan.

5. Generate and review the outline, slide text, speaker notes, and images. The story moves from the client's situation and starting point to the product, a concrete example, a credible benefit, and a next step.

6. In Publish, choose the matching PowerPoint or PDF export when ready.

Choosing a delivery format in setup does not export a file automatically.

Each descriptive pitch field has Write with AI, including Why it matters, Your pitch, and the client and product fields. You can leave a field blank: the writer uses your other pitch entries and project context to suggest wording. Give optional direction, review or refine the suggestion, and choose Use Suggestion to apply it. Keep Current leaves your text unchanged.

Use Save as Template to reuse a pitch setup for a client segment. Adjust the client, product, outcome, and angle for the next pitch. The preset supports any product; StoryTable appears in the sales story only when you choose to pitch it.

Use separate Libraries

The Active Library menu in the upper-left sidebar switches between isolated reusable collections, such as Personal and Work. Open Library and choose New Library to create an empty collection. Switching Libraries changes the reusable items offered by StoryTable; it does not move or rewrite projects. Open projects retain their saved configuration and project-owned reference snapshots.

Library-backed selectors throughout StoryTable read from the active Library catalog across project creation, Plan, Settings, and reusable-item tools. Color Scheme entries show their five-swatch palette in menus and closed selectors; From Brand and Library-thumbnail choices show their effective palettes. Saved categories are disabled headings, including empty categories. Removed items stay hidden, while unavailable project choices remain representable.

When importing a .storytable-library file, StoryTable asks whether to:

- Merge into the active Library, adding the imported items to the current collection and then resolving any matching-item conflicts; or
- Add as Separate Library, preserving the collection independently and switching to it after import.

Export Library exports only the currently active Library.

Share one item or a whole Library

Use Export Selected Type when you want to share one reusable item. The portable file contains that item and its owned local assets, such as Brand logos and imagery, Visual Style references, Layout composition references, Character references, writing samples, previews, or thumbnails. References are copied into the portable bundle; the receiving machine does not need the sender's original file paths. Per-item files intentionally do not carry the sender's folder placement or removed/restored state.

Use Export Library when you want a portable backup or transfer of the whole reusable workspace. A whole-Library file preserves reusable items, folders, folder assignments, removed/restored state, thumbnails, owned assets, and safe creative defaults. In other words, Export Library is the portable export for Library styles *and all reference material owned by those styles*. It does not contain projects, generated work, passwords, login sessions, API credentials, billing records, usage records, or logs.

When an import finds an item with the same identity, StoryTable asks whether to keep both versions, replace the matching item, or cancel/skip the conflict.

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Typical file types are:

- .storytable-library for the complete reusable Library
- .storytable-template for a Template and its reusable dependencies
- .storytable-style for a Visual Style and its owned visual assets
- .storytable-asset for the other reusable item types

From All Types, StoryTable reads a .storytable-asset file and selects its declared asset type automatically. Template and Visual Style files keep their dedicated formats for compatibility.

Manage folders

Choose one asset type, then use:

- New Folder
- Rename Folder
- Delete Folder
- Move to Folder

Folders belong to the selected asset type. Deleting a folder does not delete its assets; its items become unfiled.

Thumbnails and previews

Every Library card has either an asset thumbnail or a deterministic fallback.

- Templates use their portable preview or a layout fallback.
- Brands use a logo, imagery, or palette-based preview.
- Visual Styles use their canonical preview or a fallback. Custom generation

sends actual style references with saved directions; to preserve an existing thumbnail's subject, select its reference option or write "current thumbnail."

- Layouts use the first attached composition reference or a schematic fallback.
- Characters use their saved preview, a reference image, or a fallback.
- Text-led types use type-appropriate deterministic cards.

Missing or unreadable thumbnail sources do not make assets disappear; StoryTable uses a fallback and keeps the item manageable.

Global reference-image contract

Version 0.1.281 rebuilds image requests from current settings and tracks which settings produced saved page directions. When settings change, superseded directions are removed from the request copy; editable originals remain available. Current source-image records replace older copied analysis blocks. Reference-plan caches include the page wording, visual direction, layout, and reference treatment. The prompt audit records input cleanup as well as prompt shortening.

StoryTable reuses verified factual image readings across pages when the actual source file, reading instructions, treatment, metadata, and analysis settings still match. It builds the current page wording, layout, style, and palette around those facts each time. A duplicated page can reuse the same verified readings. Older saved analyses without verification may need one fresh reading before reuse; missing or changed source files cannot use stale evidence.

Already-current directions and clearly factual notes avoid unnecessary AI cleanup. Ambiguous older design instructions can still use semantic cleanup. Validated prompt compression can be reused during the current app session when the complete prompt, protected copy and references, capacity, and rewriting settings match. Changed inputs are checked again. Exact page copy and reference assignments remain protected, and editable originals

remain available.

Selected layout previews show the saved active-format regions. When source occupancy can be resolved, generation omits unused photo slots and raw layout guides while preserving the other regions. PDF import without a selected layout shows a flexible arrangement rather than implying fixed image/text positions. Choosing a preset replaces the prior layout direction. Its coordinates survive prompt shortening, and RTL text changes reading direction within its text region without mirroring the page layout.

Version 0.1.280 fits the complete request after its image attachments are resolved. It reduces repeated wording and low-priority explanation before style and scene requirements, preserves literal page copy and source assignments, and saves the original and sent prompts under the project's prompt_audits folder. Oversized prose is shortened automatically instead of sending pages to Needs Review. Saving an applied Visual Style or explicitly applying the same style refreshes that project's snapshot. Other projects keep their existing snapshots. When adding several images, all newly added images remain selected; analysis and reference-behavior changes apply to that selection. Findings accumulate by image, and the combined visual direction reaches generation.

Version 0.1.276 defines each Visual Style reference behavior once per page request and maps each reference to that shared definition. Complete behavior rules and individual saved directions are retained. This reduces repeated instructions; generated fidelity still requires visual review.

Version 0.1.275 applies one reference-handling contract to page artwork, Visual Style previews, Library thumbnails, Character previews and model sheets, Layout analysis, and reusable slide, social, and reel assets:

- StoryTable sends saved references in their displayed order and pairs every image with its saved role and per-image directions.
- Every Visual Style reference has one explicit behavior: Style Only, Faithful Reference Image, Background Photo (stylize only), Use As-Is, or Creative Inspiration. Choose it in the Visual Style editor for each selected reference.
- Faithful Reference Image applies the selected medium to the supplied subject, preserving identity, geometry, people, proportions and spatial relationships. Supplied references are used by default; replace one only when a specific page requirement clearly favors another supplied image. Never invent a substitute.
- Background Photo (stylize only) supplies the actual photo to treat as the page background. StoryTable selects 1 photo per page in a stable rotation, places it first in the image inputs, and retains other design/frame references. Naming a background photo's filename in Artwork Direction selects that photo. The treatment must preserve its viewpoint, room, people and poses. Typography and framing sit over the photo; they do not require rebuilding the space.
- Visual Style references are copied into managed Library storage and project snapshots. If a snapshot reference is unavailable, StoryTable first tries the matching current Library copy. Missing or unreadable required images are identified before generation; reattach or replace them rather than silently losing their evidence.
- Reference editors retain every selected image. StoryTable automatically fits larger source sets into labeled reference sheets for the image service's upload limit. Do not remove references to meet a 16-file transport limit. The mapping preserves every original source, saved role, instruction and order; sheet panels may be resized. Packing applies to page artwork, borders, slide/social/video assets, Visual Style samples and thumbnails, and Character previews and model sheets. Layout and Character analysis also accept larger sets through mapped uploads. Visual Style analysis uses ordered batches and combines the findings from every selected image.
- Generated page, style, character, and reusable-asset metadata records the ordered attachment manifest used for that result, including the saved role and directions where applicable.

When regenerating a Library thumbnail, choose the existing-thumbnail reference option, or mention current thumbnail

in the instructions, when its subject or composition must remain authoritative. If neither is selected, the saved asset references remain authoritative according to their own roles and directions.

Templates

A Template can store:

- Name and usage guidance
- Goal
- Deliverable
- Channel
- Audience
- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Context and writing/image differences
- Locked setup choices
- Portable preview

Choose Start New Project to open the guided wizard with the Template's starting choices.

Goals

A Goal records the intended communication outcome and detailed planning, writing, source-faithfulness, avoidance, and usual-writing-style direction.

Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function is a scaffold-led editorial Goal for working with several long transcripts. Put the intended viewer result, outline, or working script in the Project Brief, and mark quotation sources as Interview transcript. If the script is uploaded as a separate source, mark it Background and context so StoryTable can use it as placement direction without treating authored script copy as interview speech.

This Goal preserves the user's order and exact script or outline anchors. It selects each verified soundbite for the cinematic or literary work it performs at that point: opening a question, revealing character, creating tension, supplying proof, introducing contrast, turning the audience's understanding, releasing emotion, resolving an idea, or echoing an earlier beat. A polished or emotional quote does not outrank a passage that performs the required story function more precisely. Each selected bite retains its exact words, speaker, source, and available timing. Useful alternatives stay attached to the same anchor, while unsupported beats are identified as gaps instead of receiving a merely topical quote.

Pair this Goal with Interview Edit Script when you want the soundbite map, source provenance, review fields, and editorial handoff files. The separate Assemble an Interview Edit Script Goal remains available when you want StoryTable to discover and construct the controlling idea and narrative arc from the source material itself.

Run an Event Editorial Desk is an assignment-planning Goal for a batch of event transcripts. It first proposes source-supported single-session and cross-event stories, then lets you commission any chosen assignment as its own complete StoryTable project. That project receives the recommended Goal, Template, Deliverable, Channel, source evidence, design context, and a proposed page outline for review before artwork is generated. Use the Desk's dedicated workspace to choose assignments; each commissioned story then uses StoryTable's normal Plan, Create & Refine, versioning, and publishing workflow. See Run an Event Editorial Desk.

Deliverables

A Deliverable defines the kind of unit StoryTable should produce and how its structure works. It can specify:

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- Unit name
- Source-decided, exact, or minimum/maximum length
- Suggested project size
- Landscape or Portrait
- Sequence and timed-use expectations
- Required supporting details and other format rules

For still images, timed use describes where an image may appear in a time-based result; it does not assign playback duration to the still image itself.

Channels

A Channel describes where people experience the result. Its fields cover content, supporting material, accessibility, discovery, attention, image layout, and other destination-specific needs.

Channels can be organized into matching folders, such as a Social Media folder containing Instagram Feed, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube.

Writing Styles

A Writing Style can include name, description, audience, point of view, tone, and detailed writing instructions.

Use writing samples to analyze a style:

1. Choose writing sample files.
2. Select Analyze Writing Samples.
3. Review the AI analysis.
4. Apply only the result you want.

Analysis does not silently overwrite the style.

Brands

A Brand can include:

- Name
- Logos
- Brand imagery
- Font samples
- Five editable color swatches
- Font family
- Typography guidance
- Usage guidance

Use Choose Color for a color picker or Clear to remove a swatch. Use Extract Colors from Images when you want StoryTable to derive a palette from uploaded logo or brand imagery; the action is explicit and reviewable.

Visual Styles

A Visual Style can include:

- Name and folder
- Descriptive style fields
- Reference images, per-image behavior, and per-image guidance

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- Reference influence
- Prompt direction
- Things to avoid
- Notes
- Canonical preview

For each reference, choose how StoryTable should use it:

- Style Only learns appearance such as medium, line, texture, palette, lighting, material, framing, or composition rhythm without copying the subject.
- Faithful Reference Image applies the selected medium to the supplied subject without inventing people, spaces or major features.
- Background Photo (stylize only) uses the actual photograph as the background source and changes its rendering treatment, preserving its depicted scene.
- Use As-Is keeps the supplied visible content unchanged inside a provider-designed composition; cropping, masking, and framing remain allowed.
- Creative Inspiration permits free reinterpretation of subject and setting.

Use Analyze References to request AI-supported analysis and review it before applying it. Analyze Selected analyzes the selected references and Analyze All analyzes the complete set from the same image field. The chosen behavior and written direction accompany each image. Large Visual Style reference sets are analyzed in bounded 16-image batches. StoryTable includes every original image in order, keeps editable findings for each reference, reports the image and batch count while analysis is running, and synthesizes the batch findings into one reusable Visual Style.

Visual Style analysis reserves response capacity according to the number of reference images and the selected model's reasoning setting, including room for the shared profile and each individual finding. The same reasoning-aware capacity policy supports text writing, page planning, and source-image analysis.

While references are analyzed, a progress bar shows completed analysis steps. The status identifies the current batch, processed reference count, and the combining stage. A moving highlight and elapsed timer stay above the scrolling editor throughout the request, including waits. The percentage advances when work completes; an unknown total remains indeterminate. The final duration stays visible after completion or failure. This also applies to Character Visual Styles. If analysis fails, your existing fields remain available and the analysis button becomes available to retry. A new request resets the timer.

Additional page visual direction is optional. You can save a page plan with that field empty or clear old direction; StoryTable continues using the page text, supplied references, and current style and layout settings.

Visual Style analysis accumulates findings in General description. Analyzing another selected image retains earlier findings; reanalyzing the same filename updates that entry. The combined visual direction is regenerated from the accumulated findings. Fill fields versus Replace fields controls optional style fields, not whether prior image findings survive. Select All before analyzing to examine every attached reference.

For Visual Styles, Libraries also shows a shared Comparison Image panel. Choose or clear the comparison image used to make style previews easier to compare.

Available AI preview actions are:

- Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview
- Generate Missing Previews
- Regenerate All Previews

Layouts

A Layout is a reusable spatial composition that remains separate from subject matter and Visual Style. It can include:

- Plain-language layout directions
- Predictable orientation-reflow rules
- A starting composition
- Screenshots or composition-reference images, with every selected image retained
- Normalized landscape, portrait, and square region geometry

All saved geometry uses relative 0-100% canvas coordinates, never fixed pixel coordinates. Changing image dimensions scales the regions proportionally. Changing orientation selects the matching saved variant and preserves hierarchy and reading order instead of stretching the original arrangement. StoryTable recompiles every page that uses a saved Layout when the project orientation changes, including pages that are not currently visible.

Choose Create Layout from Selected Images after adding and selecting screenshots of a template or layout. Large reference sets are automatically grouped into mapped upload sheets. StoryTable analyzes composition only and proposes editable image, text-safe, logo, caption, callout, and background regions for all three broad orientations. It explicitly ignores the screenshot's people, story subject, wording, logos, colors, fonts, medium, texture, lighting, and artistic style. Nothing is saved until you review and confirm the Layout.

If the proposed regions overlap unintentionally or the geometry is incomplete, StoryTable requests one correction using the same references and layout directions. The status shows Correcting the proposed layout geometry.... Intended overlays remain supported. If correction fails, the message explains the layout problem and your current layout stays unchanged. Clarify which areas may overlap in the directions before analyzing again. Stop also prevents a correction request that has not yet started.

When a Layout is selected for a page, its written directions and normalized geometry are saved into that page and its reference images are copied into the project as composition-only references. The page's content supplies the subject and the selected Visual Style supplies the aesthetic.

Characters

A Character can include:

- Name
- Role
- Age or age range
- Appearance
- Clothing
- Personality
- Complete description
- Recurring details
- Reference images
- Lock state

Choose New Character to open the Character editor. To generate a preview, select or provide a Visual Style; Character preview generation uses the saved references and direction.

Use a Library item in a project

Select an active item and choose Use in Project. Layouts apply to the currently selected Page Outline page; other applicable items update their project-level role. StoryTable stores project-local data and owned references so the project remains stable and portable. Later Library edits do not silently rewrite existing projects.

Where an explicit refresh is available, such as Update from Library for a Project Character, use it to replace the project's snapshot intentionally.

12. Batch Projects

Batch Projects creates several local StoryTable projects in sequence.

Build a queue

1. Choose Add Source Files.
2. Add TXT, Markdown, or StoryTable JSON source files.
3. Choose the parent folder under Save project folders in.
4. Choose a Visual Style.
5. Review the queue.
6. Choose Start Creating.

The table shows:

- Project
- Source
- Input
- Visual Style
- Status
- Progress
- Project Folder

Control the queue

- Pause pauses when the active operation reaches a supported pause point.
- Resume continues a paused queue.
- Stop requests a safe stop; an already submitted hosted request may finish first.
- Remove Selected removes a waiting queue entry, not an already-created project folder.

Projects are processed sequentially. One failed item is recorded as failed without discarding completed items.

In the normal beta configuration, a newly written project can stop at Awaiting Review before image generation. Open that project, review its page plan, and continue deliberately.

13. Account and Settings

Account & Usage

Use Account & Usage to sign in or sign out of the StoryTable account used for hosted AI generation.

The Workspace screen shows the signed-in email, available credits, month-to-date hosted AI usage, and billing-period details when the account service provides them. Refresh Usage updates the displayed account summary. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled; StoryTable explains that state in the account summary instead of offering a purchase flow that account cannot use.

Every image action still shows its own scope-and-cost preflight before submission.

Settings

Settings contains:

- Editable default project location
- Default Visual Style
- Default Instruction Assistant
- Default image shape and orientation
- Default image quality
- Batch-project approval behavior
- Global AI model routing and a model/reasoning choice for each labeled work area
- The final-image model, image quality, transparent-asset model, and dedicated audio-transcription model
- Build information
- Check for Updates

Choose Automatic: match the selected Project Goal for Goal-specific Instruction Assistants, or choose a named Instruction Assistant to use it as the default for instruction-focused Write with AI fields. Instruction Assistants remain separate from the Writing Style used for public-facing copy.

Choose Save Defaults after making changes. Project defaults prefill the New Project wizard and remain editable in each project. Image quality applies to future image requests. Project text autosave is always on.

Choose models and reasoning by task

Under AI Generation, Automatic by task (recommended) routes each action through its labeled row. One model everywhere uses the selected one-model fallback for all writing actions while retaining the reasoning level assigned to each row. Refresh Models requests the writing-model catalog currently available to the signed-in account, so newly available compatible models can appear without a desktop-code change. StoryTable keeps a saved model visible even if it is temporarily absent from the refreshed catalog.

Version 0.1.269 starts with these task defaults:

Work area	Default model	Reasoning
Metadata, routing, classification, formatting	gpt-5.6-luna	Low
Improve instructions, captions, small rewrites	gpt-5.6-terra	Low
Transcript analysis and quote selection	gpt-5.6-terra	Medium
Narrative synthesis across interviews	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Storyboards, edit scripts, long-form articles	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Image interpretation and art direction	gpt-5.6-sol	High

Lower reasoning is generally faster. Higher reasoning gives the model more planning and synthesis time. The table is user-editable and global: once you save it, all matching StoryTable actions use those choices until you change them. A project may still contain its own Writing Style, Goal, Channel, and other creative direction; those are content instructions, not model routing.

Actual image rendering uses a specialized image model and its own Draft, Standard, or High detail quality. Audio transcription uses the dedicated speaker-diarization model shown in Settings. These are separate from the six writing/reasoning rows.

Check for Updates looks for a newer approved release for the installed platform and release channel. It does not download or install software automatically. When a newer version is available, choose Open Official Download or Remind Me Later. StoryTable also performs a quiet, non-blocking check after startup in packaged direct-download builds; offline failures do not interrupt work.

Changing the default project location does not move existing projects. Choose a different location in the guided wizard for a one-project override, a batch location in Batch Projects, or File > Save As for an open project.

14. Saving and autosave

StoryTable combines targeted autosave with explicit project saves.

Autosaved after a short pause

- Source-image review fields
- Source-image per-row instructions
- Publication captions in Plan
- Publication captions in Refine
- Page Layout selection
- Page-layout direction

StoryTable flushes pending autosaves before project navigation, opening or creating another project, saving, and closing. If an autosave fails, StoryTable can block navigation so the visible edits are not silently discarded.

Requires an explicit save

- Save Page: selected page text, art direction, accessibility text, supplied images, and other page details
- Save Project Plan: project brief, project direction, and other Plan-level changes
- Save Text in Refine: edited page text
- Header Save or Ctrl+S: the complete current project after pending autosaves are flushed

The main Save also saves the Visual Style, Brand, palette, and font currently shown in Art Direction, so those selections remain after the workspace refreshes. Apply Changes remains available to apply Art Direction directly.

Watch the nearby Saving, Saved, Saved automatically, or error status before moving on.

Save As

Use File > Save As to copy the open project to another local destination or name. StoryTable keeps the original project and selects a safe versioned destination when necessary.

15. Image states, revisions, and locks

Pending or missing

The page does not yet have an eligible current image. Use Create Image or a Create Missing/Selected/All action.

Current

The accepted current image matches the saved image-affecting page direction.

Needs Image Regeneration

An image-affecting instruction changed after the current image was created. Use **Recreate Image** on **Create**, or **Regenerate Image** on **Refine** when you also want to supply revision notes.

Changing text that is not intended to affect artwork does not necessarily require image regeneration. StoryTable uses saved image fingerprints and page state rather than treating every keystroke as a regeneration request.

Failed

The last image attempt did not finish successfully. Review the progress message and try the selected page again after resolving the cause.

Locked

The current image is protected. Bulk and selected image generation skip it. Unlock it before regenerating, removing, or restoring another version.

Skipped

The page is intentionally excluded from image batches. Choose **Include Image** to make it eligible again.

Revisions

Generated revisions are stored locally with their related prompt and metadata. **Compare** and **Restore Selected** work from that retained history.

The current generated page set is also maintained as flat, serial-numbered files in one output directory. A page's current 001.png, 001.txt, and 001.json stay together; recreating the page or restoring an earlier revision replaces that current set. Retained revision history is stored separately and does not need to be navigated for publication work.

16. Local storage, server cleanup, and security

Project storage is local and user-selected

Each project is stored in the local folder selected in the wizard or **Save As**. The default location is the configured StoryTable Projects directory, but it can be changed per project.

StoryTable copies source documents, source images, references, and project-specific Library snapshots into the project so the project does not depend on the original external file path.

Application data is separate

Protected application settings, reusable Library definitions, recovery state, and similar internal data use a private operating-system-controlled application-data location. StoryTable does not relocate that protected data when you choose a project drive.

Credentials and backend secrets do not belong in project folders. The project location controls user-generated project material only.

Generated-image server cleanup

For a hosted generated image, StoryTable:

1. Downloads the result.
2. Saves and verifies the final local file.
3. Acknowledges the successful local save to the hosted service.
4. Requests server-side result cleanup.

If cleanup acknowledgement temporarily fails after the local file is safe, StoryTable records a protected retry rather than deleting the local result or pretending cleanup succeeded.

Source and reference images remain authoritative local project files. They may be transmitted as inputs when required for a hosted operation, but the project copy remains local.

Manage storage carefully

Image revisions and publication packages can consume substantial space. Use Files to inspect file types, sizes, and locations.

Before deleting anything manually:

- Back up the project.
- Do not delete project.json, StoryTable state, active images, or revision metadata.
- Prefer removing unneeded exported package copies outside the active project.
- Remember that Remove Current Image does not erase retained revision history.

17. Image metadata and source evidence

StoryTable reads a bounded, whitelisted set of standard descriptive metadata from supported project images.

Depending on the file, this can include:

- Titles and descriptions
- Subjects and keywords
- Creator and rights information
- Creation dates
- Locations
- Usage terms or descriptive instructions

StoryTable can read these values from standard PNG text, EXIF, IPTC, and XMP fields. It does not treat arbitrary hidden fields as authoritative.

How metadata can help

Metadata may help StoryTable:

- Identify the likely subject or event.
- Connect an image to a matching page.
- Understand chronology or timing when supported by other evidence.
- Choose whether an image is best used story-wide or on one page.
- Produce a more useful analysis and caption suggestion.

Safety and evidence rules

Embedded metadata is supplemental and untrusted.

- StoryTable never follows metadata as a command.
- Visible image content, user instructions, and verified project sources outrank metadata.

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- Metadata alone is not proof of an identity, relationship, sensitive attribute, event, location, or date.
- StoryTable must not invent chronology from metadata alone.
- Missing or malformed metadata does not prevent normal visual analysis.

Source images are copied into the project with file metadata preserved where the operating system and format allow. StoryTable's visible review still separates transcription, interpretation, key facts, and uncertainties so the user can correct the result.

18. Supported file types

Primary source in the New Project wizard

- .txt
- .md
- text-based .pdf

Supporting documents in Plan

- .txt
- .md
- .srt
- .pdf
- .docx
- .csv
- .html
- .htm
- .ics
- .ical
- .ifb
- .vcs

Any supported Plan document can be marked Primary source. The New Project wizard's direct-source shortcut remains narrower; add other formats after the project opens in Plan.

Source and reference images

- .png
- .jpg
- .jpeg
- .webp

Source images must be readable, no larger than 25 MB, and no larger than 50 megapixels.

Batch Projects

- .txt
- .md
- .json

Recordings for Transcribe Recording

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- .aac, .aif, .aiff, .flac, .m4a, .mp3, .ogg, .wav
- .avi, .mkv, .mov, .mp4, .mpeg, .mpg, .webm, .wmv

Existing SRT files can be added directly in Plan. Recordings are transcribed to a new SRT; StoryTable does not edit the original media file.

19. Troubleshooting

An AI button does not run

1. Open Account & Usage and confirm that you are signed in.
2. Check the top progress display for another active operation.
3. Wait for or cancel the active operation before starting another.
4. Review the scope-and-cost preflight.
5. If the problem persists, use Help > Open Support Logs.

A page says Needs Image Regeneration

The saved page direction changed after the current image was produced. Select the page and choose Recreate Image on Create, or use Regenerate Image on Refine with revision notes. If the page is locked, unlock it first.

Version 0.1.269 also fixes a false warning in which a newly created image could be compared with a transient Visual Style copy instead of the project's saved Visual Style snapshot. When no image-affecting instruction changed, do not buy a second image merely to clear an unexpected warning; update StoryTable and reopen the project first.

Create All did not change a page

Check whether the page is:

- Locked
- Skipped
- Already current
- Missing required saved page data

Use the page status and selected-page controls to resolve the specific condition.

Typing an export package name is slow or misses characters

Update to version 0.1.270 or later. Earlier builds rebuilt the complete export preview whenever any Export Settings field changed. In a project with hundreds of finished pages, entering a package name could therefore pause the interface and miss keystrokes while StoryTable reloaded every preview thumbnail. Package name, destination, and caption edits now autosave without rebuilding the page preview. Page-selection previews refresh separately after typing pauses.

Version 0.1.270 also removes an incorrect export prerequisite that required a whole-post caption whenever One shared package caption was selected. An empty caption is valid and no longer prevents a publication or Claude Design handoff export.

An error dialog only says to try again

Version 0.1.300 removes the Workspace's generic unknown-error retry fallback. Known failures retain their specific recovery instructions. An unexpected failure displays the concise reported cause in the dialog, with credentials and unsafe service payloads redacted, and points to Help > Open Support Logs for the complete traceback. StoryTable no

longer tells you to repeat an unchanged action without saying what failed.

My edited source-image text or caption disappeared

Wait for Saved or Saved automatically before switching items. If a save error appears, remain on the page and resolve it. Use Save Now for source-image review or the header Save for the whole project.

A supplied image was redrawn

In Plan, open that page and confirm the supplied-image treatment is:

Use supplied image as-is - style around it; do not redraw

Save Page, then regenerate the image. As-is generation sends the original photo and the selected design references to the image provider to create one complete page. The photo-preservation instruction applies inside the photo region; backgrounds, frames, and surrounding design follow their own references. The provider-generated result still needs visual review for fidelity. Use Recreate the same image in the selected style when the composition should remain recognizable but the pixels may change. Use Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style only when people, content, and composition may change.

A thumbnail is blank or its source is missing

Library cards should show a deterministic fallback when the underlying preview cannot be read. For a Visual Style or Character, select the item and use Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview if an AI preview is desired.

For Visual Styles, also check the shared Comparison Image.

A project reports Recovery Needed

A project-local file recorded in the project is missing, unreadable, or fails integrity checks.

1. Do not generate over the warning.
2. Open Files or Open Project Folder to identify the missing item.
3. Restore it from backup or re-add the source/reference in Plan.
4. Save and reopen the project.

StoryTable copies imported references into the project, so deleting the original external file normally does not remove the project copy. If the project-local copy itself is missing, automatic re-upload is not guaranteed.

A source file is rejected

Check Supported file types.

- Export DOCX primary sources as text-based PDF, Markdown, or TXT.
- OCR an image-only PDF before using it as a primary source.
- Add DOCX, CSV, HTML, SRT, or calendar files from Plan > Source Documents when the New Project wizard's narrower direct-source shortcut does not list them.

Save Project Plan says nothing was changed

Do not discard the open project. Choose Help > Open Support Logs and keep the project open until you know whether its latest edits reached disk.

Version 0.1.265 and later allow a project with an empty Project Brief to save. The brief is useful direction, but it is not a save prerequisite. It also displays a successfully attached Source Document immediately, before any unrelated Plan

field is autosaved. A validation problem elsewhere in the Plan can no longer make a durable attachment appear to have disappeared from the table.

Version 0.1.264 fixed a separate case where a CSV marked Primary source was accepted and analyzed in Plan but rejected when the project plan tried to save it through an older single-source validator.

If you must preserve work in an earlier version before updating, temporarily change the CSV's Purpose to Supporting source, save the plan, and then close StoryTable. Reopen the project after installing 0.1.264 and restore the intended Primary source purpose.

If an earlier build reports that a source is attached but its Source Documents table is blank, do not repeatedly import the file. Keep the project open until you confirm the project-local copy exists. After installing 0.1.265 or later, reopen the project; StoryTable reloads the registered source and displays its row.

A Template card reverts after you leave Project setup

Version 0.1.269 makes each Template card a direct, persistent choice. Selecting a different card asks for confirmation when the project already contains work, then applies and saves that Template immediately. Apply Template remains available for intentionally reapplying the currently selected Template after its Library definition changes. In earlier builds, a card click only changed a hidden temporary selection, so the next Plan refresh restored the saved Template and appeared to undo the click. Version 0.1.269 also corrects the application-service lookup used by that direct action so choosing a Template cannot crash before the selection is saved.

A Goal card changes back, or opening Export reports a deleted control

Install version 0.1.315 or later. Earlier card-based Project Setup screens could leave the hidden Brand selector owned by an obsolete temporary row. When Qt cleaned up that row, the next delayed save could reload the previously saved Goal and then fail on the deleted selector. A newly chosen Goal could therefore appear to change back to Teach or Explain. Moving to Export while the same save was pending could instead report that a QComboBox had already been deleted.

Version 0.1.315 keeps delayed saves connected only to the current live controls. A selected Goal remains selected after the save completes, and moving to Export can safely finish any pending Plan save.

A grouped roster produced only one page

The Event Poster Set Template uses a source-driven Graphic Set, not the one-item Single Graphic contract. For birthday rosters, StoryTable builds and audits the complete grouping instead of accepting the first date as a sample.

If an older project still displays Event Promotion Graphic or Single Graphic, install 0.1.269 and re-author the outline. The saved source and Project Brief remain authoritative; you do not need to re-upload the roster.

A batch item stops at Awaiting Review

This is expected in the normal beta configuration. Open the created project, review the page text and outline, then continue image generation from Create.

Credits or cost are a concern

Use the preflight to confirm the actionable page count and estimate. Generate only Missing, Selected, or the current page instead of All when appropriate. Account & Usage shows available credits and usage when the signed-in account can provide them. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled.

The project is using too much disk space

1. Open Files and sort your review by Type and Size.
2. Identify redundant publication package copies outside the active project.
3. Preserve active images, project state, prompts, and revision metadata.
4. Back up the project before manual cleanup.

An operation was interrupted

Reopen the project and review Overview, page statuses, and the top progress display. StoryTable preserves completed local work and records recovery information, but do not assume an interrupted page succeeded until its current image and status can be verified.

Stop ends the desktop's wait for supported hosted work. The original task may continue on the service; stopping the wait does not confirm that the task was canceled or failed. StoryTable keeps its saved task identity so the same action can check the earlier task. If a connection interruption prevents a status check, StoryTable reports a recoverable interruption rather than claiming that generation failed. It does not automatically submit a new generation to replace that task.

If hosted work was still queued or running when the connection was interrupted or you stopped waiting, run the same unchanged action to check its saved task. Keep its project and generation inputs unchanged so StoryTable can identify the original request. This status check does not require a new generation merely because five minutes have elapsed. A recoverable interruption describes the desktop's connection to the task; its final result still needs to be confirmed by the service and applied to the project.

AI reports that its response reached a length limit

A response limit can be reached while the model reasons about a single page, before it finishes returning the requested plan. StoryTable reserves room for both reasoning and the completed response. Page re-analysis asks for concise values for every required field and checks the result before applying it.

For the Event Editorial Desk, StoryTable uses the selected model's full supported output allowance and automatically retries a confirmed hosted length-limit once with a more concise assignment-desk request. Completed transcript analysis stays saved and is reused; the retry does not analyze or charge for those transcript sections again. The current project and any prior desk remain unchanged until a complete replacement is ready.

The Event Editorial Desk requires at least one complete, readable transcript. Its Coverage Brief is optional. Working headlines, source focus, evidence reasons, and assignment details are generated by StoryTable and are not fields you must complete. If a message says StoryTable finished synthesis but could not apply the result because of an internal routing limit, retry the same unchanged Analyze Transcripts & Find Stories action. StoryTable checks the completed saved task instead of submitting and charging for another generation.

If this message continues after updating StoryTable, open Help > Open Support Logs and report the action, project type, and version. Keep your existing page text and source-image assignments while the failure is investigated. A Completed in duration beside the Project Brief belongs to that writing action; the top operation display reports a separate page-analysis run.

I need diagnostic information

Choose Help > Open Support Logs. Include the version and build from Settings in your report.

20. Menu and keyboard reference

File

- New Project - Ctrl+N
- Open Project - Ctrl+O
- Save - Ctrl+S
- Save As - Ctrl+Shift+S
- Exit

Help

- StoryTable User Manual
- Tutorials
- Open Support Logs
- Check for Updates...

This Markdown file is canonical. A release fails when its application version does not match the manual edition marker. Its PDF is packaged in the app, attached to the release, and published at <https://www.storytable.app/manual>.

The first color in a palette is its Primary accent. In Plan, Create & Refine's Art Direction, or the Color Scheme editor, choose a different existing color from the Primary accent dropdown to move it into the first position. The other colors keep their relative order. Rotate Colors moves the first color to the end and brings the next color forward; five clicks restore the original five-color order. Both controls retain the same color values. Workspace changes belong to the current output; use the Library editor to change a reusable scheme. In Create & Refine, choose Apply Changes to save the new order, or Apply and Regenerate to see it in new artwork. Save and starting image generation also save pending Art Direction edits.

Use Color Harmony... beneath the Art Direction palette to open the color tools with the currently displayed colors. Explore analogous and other harmonies, then choose Save and Use to apply the new scheme to this project. Cancel leaves the project unchanged. Existing artwork changes when regenerated.